

Katerina Zinich

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Product and Digital Designer with six years of experience connecting user needs with product strategy and business outcomes. I specialise in managing the entire product lifecycle, from initial research and MVP strategy to high-fidelity delivery. I have a proven record of aligning stakeholder goals with engineering teams to build intuitive, commercially viable platforms for both enterprise retailers and agile startups. I am WCAG 2.2 certified, ensuring all digital products meet the highest standards of web accessibility and inclusive design.

Experience

UX/UI Designer (Freelance)

Various Clients | November 2025 – Present

I collaborate with startups to distil initial concepts into structured, scalable products. My focus is on grounding product development in user evidence and strategic roadmapping.

- **Research and Strategy:** Conducted in-depth user interviews and research to identify core pain points and market opportunities.
- **MVP Definition:** Defined Minimum Viable Products by prioritising features that balance user needs with immediate business goals.
- **Design System Creation:** Built and documented scalable design systems from the ground up. This ensured visual consistency and provided a clear library for tech squads to accelerate development.
- **Implementation Roadmapping:** Developed detailed roadmaps for product implementation to ensure a clear path from design to launch.
- **Technical Integration:** Collaborated with developers to align design specifications with technical sprints, ensuring timely and high-quality releases.

Digital engagement designer (UX/UI)

Officeworks | Dec 2024 – Sep 2025

In this role for a high-traffic e-commerce platform, I turned user insights into measurable business results. I worked with cross-functional teams to ensure that complex digital projects remained user-friendly and technically feasible.

- **Stakeholder Partnership:** Engaged business and IT leads to translate high-level objectives into technical design artefacts, ensuring alignment across the product vision.
- **Data-Driven Iteration:** Used analytics and user feedback to refine front-end UI. This successfully reduced bounce rates and improved the customer journey during peak periods.
- **Cross-Functional Collaboration:** Balanced usability with technical constraints alongside engineers and product leads to ensure seamless execution.
- **Process Efficiency:** Introduced pre-development UI validation workshops to catch issues early. This streamlined the handover process and led to faster decision-making.

UX/UI Designer (Freelance)

Various Clients / Sep 2019 – Dec 2024

I led end-to-end design projects for a range of clients. I focused on identifying pain points and developing innovative solutions that turned concepts into launch-ready products.

- **Product Strategy and MVP:** Partnered with startup founders to define product requirements, creating user journeys and core features that solved real user problems.
- **End-to-End Delivery:** Developed full-cycle deliverables, including interactive prototypes and high-fidelity visuals, to ensure an intuitive user experience.
- **Research and Validation:** Conducted user research to identify behaviours and motivations. I used these insights to validate design choices and improve user retention.
- **Scalable Design Systems:** Established and evolved design systems and brand guidelines to ensure consistency across products and smoother developer handoffs.
- **Commercial Impact:** Led design overhauls that directly supported business growth. This included achieving a 36% lift in seasonal campaign sales through improved UI.

Education

Institute of Modern Art
Bachelor of Arts / June 2007

Animation Lyceum
Advanced Diploma of Arts / June 2002

Liz Brown
WCAG 2.2 Web Accessibility / March 2026

Technical Toolkit

- Primary Design Tool: Figma (Design Systems, Prototyping, Component Architecture)
- Accessibility: WCAG 2.2 Compliance, Screen Reader Testing, Colour Contrast Analysis, Inclusive Design Audit
- AI-Enhanced Workflow: Antigravity (Rapid Prototyping), LLMs for Thematic Research Clustering and Interview Scripting.
- Creative Suite: Adobe XD, Photoshop, Illustrator, Firefly
- Analytics & Research: Hotjar, Adobe Analytics, Google Lighthouse, SEMrush
- Project Management: Jira, Confluence, Monday (Agile Methodology)
- Technical Knowledge: HTML, CSS, and various CMS (Shopify, Webflow, Contentful)